

Creatures

Creatures are one of the types of Actors that are used in MgT2e. They are simpler than any of the other actor types, and represent (normally) non-sophont critters that are mostly just there as targets in combat.

Properties

Creatures have two primary properties that are unique to them - *Behaviours* and *Traits*.

These are defined under MGT2.CREATURES. They are a list of hard-coded values which can be applied to a creature. Some are just markers, others modify the actor's other attributes.

All behaviours and traits have a name, which must be purely alphabetical ([a-zA-Z]), with no spaces or special characters. It is customary to use camelcase, e.g. "myTrait" or "superHearing" etc.

It is also important that traits and behaviour names aren't a substring of another one. So if there is a trait "heightenedSenses", do not create a trait called "height".

Behaviours

Behaviours are defined by MGT2.CREATURES.behaviours. They represent how the creature behaves, as per the Mongoose Traveller core rules.

For example:

```
"scavenger": { "skills": [], "group": "diet" },  
"metal": { "skills": [], "group": "diet" },  
"carrionEater": { "skills": ["recon"] },  
"chaser": { "skills": [ "athletics.dexterity", "athletics.endurance" ] },
```

skills is an array of skills that the behaviour causes to be 'trained'. Any creature with that behaviour will be trained in the listed skills. The array is required, but may be empty.

group defines a CSS class to apply to the listed behaviour. Currently it is just used to display the primary behaviours (herbivore, omnivore, carnivore etc) in a darker shade.

There must be a localization value for the behaviour, as well as the hover text that is associated with the behaviour:

```
"MGT2.Creature.Behaviour.newBehaviour":      "New Behaviour"  
"MGT2.Creature.BehaviourText.newBehaviour":  "This creature exhibits new behaviour"
```

Traits

Traits are defined by MGT2.CREATURES.traits. They represent special abilities that the creature has. Like behaviours, they are options that are applied to the creature. They have a more complicated set of properties though.

For example:

```
"fastMetabolism": { "set": "initiative.base", "min": 1, "max": 6, "conflict": "initiative.base"},
"floater": {},
"flyer": { "default": 3, "choices": [ "idle", "verySlow", "slow", "medium", "fast" ] },
"gigantic": { "value": 1, "min": 1, "max": 6 },
```

set overrides a property on the actor. In the above case, “fast-Metabolism” sets initiative. min and max define a range for numeric properties. They default to 1 and 21 if not defined. conflict specifies a trait that is incompatible with this trait. Normally there will be pairs of traits which conflict with each other. If one is selected, then the other can’t be. choices provides a list of options for this trait. default defines the default index (zero based) in the list of choice options. value means a number will be shown next to the trait. It doesn’t apply to anything, it’s just something for the GM and players to see.

Just as for Behaviours, there must be localization values defined:

“MGT2.Creature.Trait.newTrait”: “New Trait”

If a trait has choices defined, then each choice must also be purely alphabetical, and uses localization to define what text is displayed:

```
“MGT2.Creature.TraitChoice.newTrait.choice0”: “First Choice”,
“MGT2.Creature.TraitChoice.newTrait.choice1”: “Middle Choice”,
“MGT2.Creature.TraitChoice.newTrait.choice2”: “Last Choice”,
```